

PODIUM A platform used to raise a building off the ground.

PORTCULLIS A vertically closing gate typically found in medieval fortifications. It was often constructed of a lattice of wood reinforced with metal.

PORTICO A roofed space, usually supported by columns, forming an entrance and often the central feature of a facade.

PROPYLAEUM A monumental gateway in ancient Greek architecture.

PROSCENIUM In Greek theater, a narrow raised platform on which actors performed. In the Roman era, it referred specifically to the vertical front dropping from the stage to the floor of the orchestra.

PYLON A monumental structure that served as a gateway to an ancient Egyptian temple. Pylons took the form of giant vertical slabs that sloped inward to the top.

Q

QIBLA The direction of Mecca, toward which Muslims face when they perform prayer. In a mosque, the direction is marked by the *mihrab*, and the wall in which the *mihrab* is set is known as the *qibla* wall. *See also* mosque.

QUADRIGA A sculpture depicting a chariot drawn by four horses harnessed abreast that often appears on ancient Roman victory monuments or triumphal arches.

RELIEF CARVING

This is a technique in which designs are carved into a flat piece or panel of wood, stone, or other material so that figures and patterns project from the background. If the design projects only slightly from the background and there is no undercutting of the outline, the work is known as low- or bas-relief. If the design projects more prominently, with parts that may be completely disengaged from the background, approximating sculpture, it is known as high- or alto-relief.

design only slightly raised from background



BAS-RELIEF

both sculptures are carved against a flat background

part of design is separate from background

design projects slightly more from background



ALTO-RELIEF

QUEEN POST One of two posts that work together to support a structure. *See also* king post, truss.

QUEEN TRUSS Similar to a king truss, except it employs two posts and can span longer openings than a king truss. *See also* king truss, truss.

QUOIN A decorative corner stone on a wall. Quoins differ in size, color, or texture from the rest of the masonry used in the wall. They are often toothed—that is, set in a pattern of alternating lengths with one short and one long.

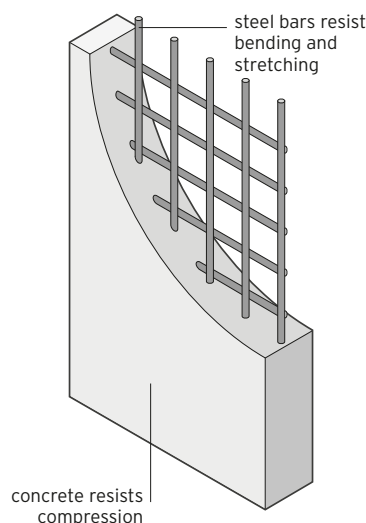
R

RATIONALISM An architectural style practiced in Italy from the 1920s to the 1940s that married Neo-Classicism with Modernism. It was characterized by symmetrical plans, rhythmic colonnades (with columns repeating at regular intervals), the use of columns and arches, and marble slab coating.

It was promoted by the fascist regime of Benito Mussolini. *See also* Modernism, Neo-Classicism.

REINFORCED CONCRETE ▼

Concrete strengthened by having steel reinforcing bars embedded within it before it sets. The steel adds tensile strength to complement the natural compressive strength of the concrete.



RELIEF CARVING *See* panel, above.

RELIEVING ARCH An arch built over a lintel to redistribute weight away from the lintel. It is also known as a discharging arch. *See also* lintel.

RENAISSANCE ARCHITECTURE

A style that was developed first in Florence but which spread throughout Europe from the early 14th century onward. It revived elements of ancient Greek and Roman architecture and stood in stark contrast to the Gothic architecture that preceded it. It favored the reintroduction of columns, colonnades, Classical orders, arches, and domes.

RETAINING WALL ▼ A wall that holds back a mass of soil, such as in garden terracing.

